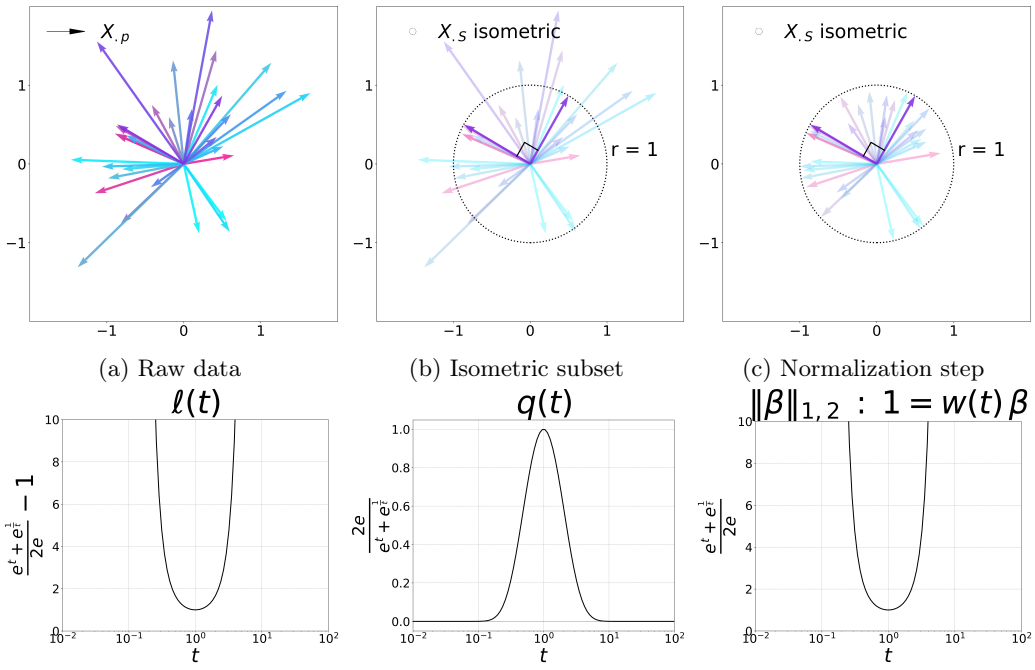


(a) Raw data (b) Isometric subset (c) Normalization step

(d) Ground truth loss (e) Normalized length vs. unnormalized length (f) Basis pursuit loss

Figure 1: 1a Raw data X represented as column-vectors. 1b An isometric subset - the identification of which is our objective. 1c The vectors after normalization so that vectors of length 1 maintain longest length. 1d Our ground truth loss function in the one-dimensional case $D = 1$ 1e Normalized length used to rescale Figure 1a to get vectors in Figure 1c. 1f Basis pursuit loss. This loss is equivalent to that shown in Figure 1d in the one-dimensional case.

Isometry Pursuit: Convex Recovery of Orthonormal Column Submatrices

Anonymous authors
Paper under double-blind review

Abstract

Isometry pursuit is a convex algorithm for identifying orthonormal column-submatrices of wide matrices. It consists of a vector normalization followed by multitask basis pursuit. Applied to Jacobians of putative coordinate functions, it helps identity locally isometric embeddings from within interpretable dictionaries. We provide theoretical and experimental results justifying this method, including a proof with realistic assumptions that such isometric submatrices, should they exist, are contained within the obtained support. For problems involving coordinate selection and diversification, it offers a synergistic alternative to greedy and brute force search.

1 Method

We apply the multitask basis pursuit paradigm used to select independent dictionary elements in Koelle et al. (2022; 2024) to the more specific problem of selecting pointwise isometries

Table 1: Matrix loss functions evaluated for isometry pursuit. We evaluate four key properties: whether the loss has a unique minimum, whether it is minimized specifically at orthonormal matrices (isometries), whether it prefers unit-length vectors over scaled versions, and whether it prefers orthogonal (orthonormal) structure.

Loss Function	**Definition**	**Unique min.**	**Min. at isometry**	**Prefers unit-length**	**Prefers orthogonal**
Distortion[Kohli et al. (2021)]	$\sigma_{\max}(X)/\sigma_{\min}(X)$	No	Yes	No	Yes
Isometry loss	$\sum_{d=1}^{D} g(\sigma_d(X))$	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
S-divergence to identity	$\log\det\left((X^\top X + I_D)/2\right) - \frac{1}{2}\log\det(X^\top X)$	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Normalized log-det volume	$-\sum_{d=1}^{D}\log\sigma_d\left(n_q^{\times P}(X)\right)$	No	No	Yes	No
Frobenius norm	$\|n_g^{\times P}(X)\|_F$	No	No	Yes	No
Frob. pseudoinverse	$\|n_q^{\times P}(X)^\dagger\|_F$	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
IsometryPursuit[Yuan and Lin (2006)]	$\arg\min_\beta \|\beta\|_{1,2} : I_D = w^{\times P}(X)\beta$	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

from a dictionary. We first define a ground truth objective computable via brute and greedy algorithms that is uniquely minimized by orthonormal matrices. We then define the combination of normalization and multitask basis pursuit that approximates this ground truth loss function. We finally give a brute post-processing method for ensuring that the solution is D sparse, and provide a theoretical result that the two stage approach will always result in recovery of an isometric solution from the dictionary, should one exist.

1.1 Ground truth

We'd like a ground truth objective to be minimized uniquely by orthonormal matrices, invariant under rotation, and depend on all changes in the matrix. Deformation (Kohli et al., 2021) and nuclear norm (Boyd and Vandenberghe, 2004) use only a subset of the differential's information and are not uniquely minimized at unitarity, respectively. We therefore introduce an alternative ground truth objective that satisfies the above desiderata and has convenient connections to isometry pursuit.

This ground truth objective is

$$\ell : \mathbb{R}^{D\times P} \to \mathbb{R}^+ \tag{1}$$

$$X \mapsto \sum_{d=1}^{D} g(\sigma_d(X)) \tag{2}$$

where $\sigma_d(X)$ is the d-th singular value of X and

$$g : \mathbb{R}^+ \to \mathbb{R}^+ \tag{3}$$

$$t \mapsto \frac{e^t + e^{t^{-1}}}{2e}. \tag{4}$$

By Proposition **??**, we can see that ℓ is uniquely maximized by orthonormal matrices. Moreover, g is convex, and $\ell(X^{-1}) = \ell(X)$ when X is invertible. Figure 1d gives a graph of ℓ when $D = 1$.

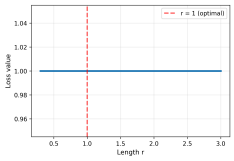
Our ground truth objective is therefore the best subset selection problem

$$\arg\min_{S\in\binom{[P]}{d}} \ell(X_{\cdot S}). \tag{5}$$

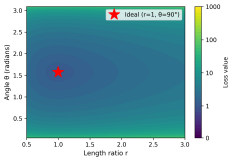
Regardless of the convexity of ℓ, brute combinatorial search over $[P]$ is inherently non-convex. This motivates our alternative formulation.

1.2 Normalization

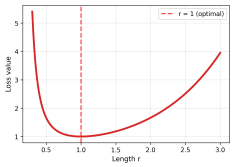
Since basis pursuit methods tend to select longer vectors, selection of orthonormal submatrices requires normalization such that both long and short candidate basis vectors are penalized in the subsequent regression. We introduce the following definition.



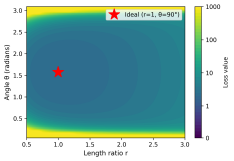
(a) Distortion 1D



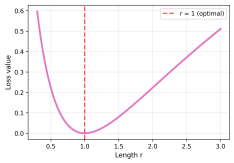
(b) Distortion 2D



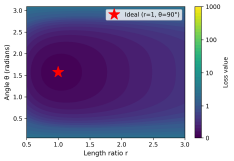
(c) Isometry loss 1D



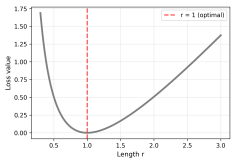
(d) Isometry loss 2D



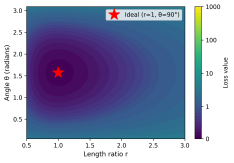
(e) S-divergence 1D



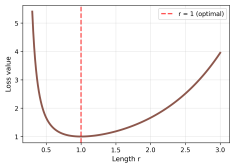
(f) S-divergence 2D



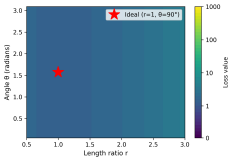
(g) Norm. log-det 1D



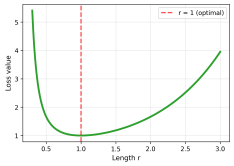
(h) Norm. log-det 2D



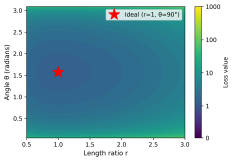
(i) Frob. norm 1D



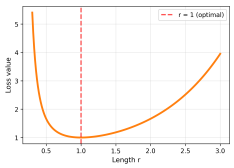
(j) Frob. norm 2D



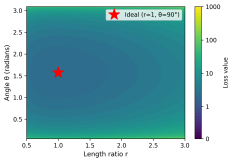
(k) Frob. pseudoinv. 1D



(l) Frob. pseudoinv. 2D



(m) Isometry pursuit 1D



(n) Isometry pursuit 2D

Figure 2: Comprehensive loss function comparison for isometry pursuit (7 rows × 2 columns). Left column: 1D loss curves for $X = [[r]]$ showing loss behavior versus vector length. Right column: 2D loss landscapes for 2×2 matrices parametrized by length ratio r and angle θ with shared colorbars. Red vertical dashed line in 1D plots marks $r = 1$ (optimal). Red star in 2D plots marks $(r = 1, \theta = \pi/2)$ (ideal). The panels visualize whether each candidate loss prefers unit-length and orthogonal structure at the ideal point. See Table 1 for mathematical definitions.

Definition 1 (Symmetric normalization) *A function $q : \mathbb{R}^D \to \mathbb{R}^+$ is a symmetric normalization if*

$$\arg\max_{v\in\mathbb{R}^D} \; q(v) = \{v : \|v\|_2 = 1\} \tag{6}$$

$$q(v) = q(\frac{v}{\|v\|_2^2}) \tag{7}$$

$$q(v_1) = q(v_2) \; \forall \; v_1, v_2 \in \mathbb{R}^D : \|v_1\|_2 = \|v_2\|_2. \tag{8}$$

We use such functions to normalize column-vector length in such a way that vectors of length 1 prior to normalization have longest length after normalization and vectors are shrunk proportionately to their deviation from 1. That is, we normalize vectors by

$$n : \mathbb{R}^D \to \mathbb{R}^D \tag{9}$$

$$v \mapsto q(v)\frac{v}{\|v\|_2} \tag{10}$$

and matrices by

$$w : \mathbb{R}^{D\times P} \to \mathbb{R}^{D\times P} \tag{11}$$

$$X_{.p} \mapsto n(X_{.p}) \; \forall \; p \in [P]. \tag{12}$$

We choose q as follows.

$$q : \mathbb{R}^D \to \mathbb{R}^+ \tag{13}$$

$$v \mapsto \frac{2e}{e^{\|v\|_2} + e^{\|v\|_2^{-1}}}. \tag{14}$$

Besides satisfying the conditions in Definition 1, this normalization has some additional nice properties. First, q is convex. Second, it grows asymptotically log-linearly. Third, while $\exp(-|\log t|) = \exp(-\max(t, 1/t))$ is a seemingly natural choice for normalization, it is non smooth, and the LogSumExp (Boyd and Vandenberghe, 2004) replacement of $\max(t, 1/t)$ with $\log(\exp(t)+\exp(1/t))$ simplifies to 14 upon exponentiation. This normalization provides good numerical properties for avoiding issues arising close to 0 and ∞. We plot this normalization function in Figure 1e and its effect on our example data in Figure 1c.

1.3 Isometry pursuit

Isometry pursuit is the application of multitask basis pursuit to the normalized design matrix $w(X)$ to identify submatrices of X that are as orthonormal as possible. Define the multitask basis pursuit penalty

$$\|\cdot\|_{1,2} : \mathbb{R}^{P\times D} \to \mathbb{R}^+ \tag{15}$$

$$\beta \mapsto \sum_{p=1}^{P} \|\beta_{p.}\|_2. \tag{16}$$

Given a matrix $Y \in \mathbb{R}^{D\times D}$, the multitask basis pursuit solutions are

$$\widehat{\beta}_{MBP}(X, Y) := \arg\min_{\beta\in\mathbb{R}^{P\times D}} \|\beta\|_{1,2} \; : \; Y = X\beta. \tag{17}$$

The multitask basis pursuit solution is often not unique. See Schneider and Tardivel (2022) for more details on uniqueness of basis pursuit solutions, for which the uniqueness condition is less strict than in the multitask case. We therefore define

$$\widehat{\beta}^{\ell_2}_{MLP}(X, Y) := \arg\min \|\beta\|_F : \beta \in \beta_{MBP}(X, Y). \tag{18}$$

By the strong convexity of the ℓ_2 norm, $\widehat{\beta}^{\ell_2}_{MLP}(X, Y)$ is well defined.

This implicit regularization assumption is reasonable. For example, in Tibshirani (2012) the implicit selection of the minimum ℓ_2 norm solution among the lasso solutions was proven for the Least Angle Regression Selection (LARS) algorithm for solving the lasso, while Mishkin and Pilanci (2022) assumes that the group lasso solution is in fact min-norm prior to subsequent theoretical analyses. Empirically, the Splitting Conic Solver type method (which is itself a variant of the Alternating Direction Method of Multilpliers) (O'Donoghue et al., 2013) stably estimates the min-norm solution when initialized at 0, but besides a brief exploration in Section **??** we leave theoretical and experimental proof of this feature of the feature our optimization approach for future work, and instead make the ability of our optimizer to obtain the min-norm solution an assumption of our eventual proposition.

Isometry pursuit is then given by

$$\widehat{\beta}(X) := \widehat{\beta}^{\ell_2}_{MBP}(w(X), I_D) \tag{19}$$

where I_D is the D dimensional identity matrix and recovered functions are the indices of the dictionary elements with non-zero coefficients. That is, they are given by $S(\beta)$ where

$$S : \mathbb{R}^{P\times D} \to \binom{[P]}{D} \tag{20}$$

$$\beta \mapsto \{p \in [P] : \|\beta_{p\cdot}\| > 0\}\,. \tag{21}$$

IsometryPursuit(Matrix $X \in \mathbb{R}^{D\times P}$)

1: Normalize $X' = w(X)$
2: Optimize $\widehat{\beta} = \widehat{\beta}^{\ell_2}_{MBP}(X', I_D)$
3: **Output** $\widehat{S} = S(\widehat{\beta})$

1.4 Theory

The intuition behind our application of multitask basis pursuit is that submatrices consisting of vectors which are closer to 1 in length and more orthogonal will have smaller loss. A key theoretical assertion is that IsometryPursuit is invariant to choice of basis for X.

Proposition 1 *Let $U \in \mathbb{R}^{D\times D}$ be orthonormal. Then $S(\widehat{\beta}(UX)) = S(\widehat{\beta}(X))$.*

This proposition establishes the basis-independence of Isometry Pursuit and that we may replace I_D in the constraint by any orthonormal $D \times D$ matrix. It is also essential for showing the following main theoretical result.

When a rank D orthonormal column-submatrix $X_{\cdot S}$ exists, the output of Program 19 will contain S.

Proposition 2 *Let $X \in \mathbb{R}^{D\times P}$ have a rank D orthonormal column submatrix $X_{\cdot S}$. Then $S \subseteq \widehat{\beta}(X)$.*

Proofs of these propositions are given in Section 2.2, with corresponding experimental results in Section **??**. The proof mostly relies on the KKT conditions (Hastie et al., 2015) being used to verify that an isometric subset yields a corresponding basis pursuit solution for an appropriate normalized matrix. This is a formalization of our intuition that longer and more orthogonal vectors will minimize loss. We then apply a simple argument to show that the ℓ_2 minimizing solution is the least sparse solution, which means that it contains the isometry solution, should it exist.

1.5 Two-stage isometry pursuit

Proposition 2 suggests the following algorithm, which first uses the convex IsometryPursuit algorithm to prune the P candidate features and then applies brute search upon the reduced feature set. The proposition says that this approach is guaranteed to select an

isometric submatrix should one exist. The two-stage approach is standard in the Lasso literature (Meinshausen, 2007; Hesterberg et al., 2008; Koelle et al., 2022), and Proposition 2 justifies it in our application. This method forms our practical isometry estimator, the core advantage of which over purely brute search is a substantially improved computational complexity.

TwoStageIsometryPursuit(Matrix $X \in \mathbb{R}^{D \times P}$)

1: $\widehat{S}_{IP} = \text{IsometryPursuit}(X)$
2: $\widehat{S} = \text{BruteSearch}(X_{\cdot \widehat{S}_{IP}}, \ell)$
3: **Output** $\widehat{S}$

1.6 Non-uniqueness

The isometric solution is optimum among cardinality D solutions.

Proposition 3 $\ell(X_S) = D, |S| = D \Leftrightarrow X_S X_S^T = I_D$

However, there exist Isometry Pursuit solutions of minimum norm that are not isometries. For example, *Mercedes-Benz frame* matrix X achieves minimium norm.

Example 1 *Let* $D = 2, P = 3$. *Let* $X_S = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \\ 1 & -\frac{1}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \end{bmatrix}, \beta = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \frac{2}{3} \\ \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} & -\frac{1}{3} \\ -\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} & -\frac{1}{3} \end{bmatrix}$ *Then* $X\beta = I_D$ *and* $\|\beta\|_{1,2} = \frac{2}{3} + \frac{2}{3} + \frac{2}{3} = 2 = D$. *Since the identity matrix is a solution regardless of* X_{-S}, *this is a non-isometric minimum loss solution.*

The upshot of this example is that IsometryPursuit can select solutions that are relatively non-isometric. The Mercedes-Benz frame is an example of a tight frame - a frame whose non-zero singular values are equal. While there are non-tight frames that have minimizing solutions, we do not here resolve whether there exist tight frames with unit norm columns that have minimum norm solutions.

1.7 Computation complexity

IsometryPursuit is more computationally efficient than BruteSearch search for the minimizer of ℓ. Interestingly, their asymptotic per-iteration complexities are the same.

Proposition 4 *The computational complexity* C_ℓ *of 1 is* $O(D^2 P)$.

The above proposition follows immediately from the computational complexity of singular value decomposition (Liang et al., 2016). The per-iteration complexity of IsometryPursuit is also limited by the computational complexity of singular value decomposition, albeit in the more intricate manner described in Section 2.2.4.

Proposition 5 *The computational complexity of each step of Isometry Pursuit is* $O(D^2 P)$.

The difference therefore lies in the relation of the number of iterations required to achieve a given error tolerance with IsometryPursuit and BruteSearch. To optimize, we use the SCS interior point solver (O'Donoghue et al., 2016) from CVXPY (Diamond and Boyd, 2016; Agrawal et al., 2018), which is able to push sparse values arbitrarily close to 0 (CVXPY Developers). SCS (aka ADMM) has asymptotic (in error) accuracy $\epsilon < O(\frac{1}{\mathcal{S}})$, where $\mathcal{S}$ is the number of iterations (He and Yuan, 2012). This means that the number of iterations required to achieve a given error tolerance scales inversely with the desired level of accuracy. We examine the effect of iteration number on the convergence to a sparse solution in Section **??**.

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2 Supplement

This section contains algorithms, proofs, and experiments in support of the main text.

2.1 Algorithms

We give definitions of the brute and greedy algorithms for the combinatorial problem studied in this paper. The brute force algorithm is computationally intractable for all but the smallest problems, but always finds the global minima.

BruteSearch(Matrix $X \in \mathbb{R}^{D \times P}$, objective f)

1: **for** each combination $S \subseteq \{1, 2, \ldots, P\}$ with $|S| = D$ **do**
2: Evaluate $f(X_{.S})$
3: **end for**
4: **Output** the combination S^* that minimizes $f(X_{.S})$

Greedy algorithms are computationally expedient but can get stuck in local optima (Cormen et al., 2009; Russell and Norvig, 2009), even with randomized restarts (Dick et al., 2014).

GreedySearch(Matrix $X \in \mathbb{R}^{D \times P}$, objective f, selected set $S = \emptyset$, current size $d = 0$)

1: **if** $d = D$ **then**
2: **Return** S
3: **else**
4: **Initialize** $S_{\text{best}} = S$
5: **Initialize** $f_{\text{best}} = \infty$
6: **for** each $p \in \{1, 2, \ldots, P\} \setminus S$ **do**
7: **Evaluate** $f(X_{.(S \cup \{p\})})$
8: **if** $f(X_{.(S \cup \{p\})}) < f_{\text{best}}$ **then**
9: **Update** $S_{\text{best}} = S \cup \{p\}$
10: **Update** $f_{\text{best}} = f(\mathcal{X}_{.(S \cup \{p\})})$
11: **end if**
12: **end for**
13: **Return** GreedySearch(X, f, S_{best}, $d + 1$)
14: **end if**

2.2 Proofs

2.2.1 Proof of Proposition 1

In this proof we first show that the penalty $\|\beta\|_{1,2}$ is unchanged by unitary transformation of β.

Proposition 6 *Let $U \in \mathbb{R}^{D \times D}$ be unitary. Then $\|\beta\|_{1,2} = \|\beta U\|$.*

Proof:

$$\|\beta U\|_{1,2} = \sum_{p=1}^{P} \|\beta_{p.} U\| \tag{22}$$

$$= \sum_{p=1}^{P} \|\beta_{p.}\| \tag{23}$$

$$= \|\beta\|_{1,2} \tag{24}$$

□

We then show that this implies that the resultant loss is unchanged by unitary transformation of X.

Proposition 7 *Let $U \in \mathbb{R}^{D\times D}$ be unitary. Then $\widehat{\beta}(UX) = \widehat{\beta}(X)U$.*

Proof:

$$\widehat{\beta}(UX) = \arg\min_{\beta\in\mathbb{R}^{P\times D}} \|\beta\|_{1,2} \ : \ I_D = UX\beta \tag{25}$$

$$= \arg\min_{\beta\in\mathbb{R}^{P\times D}} \|\beta\|_{1,2} \ : \ U^{-1}U = U^{-1}UX\beta U \tag{26}$$

$$= \arg\min_{\beta\in\mathbb{R}^{P\times D}} \|\beta\|_{1,2} \ : \ I_D = X\beta U \tag{27}$$

$$= \arg\min_{\beta\in\mathbb{R}^{P\times D}} \|\beta U\|_{1,2} \ : \ I_D = X\beta U \tag{28}$$

$$= \arg\min_{\beta\in\mathbb{R}^{P\times D}} \|\beta\|_{1,2} \ : \ I_D = X\beta. \tag{29}$$

□

2.2.2 Proof of Proposition 2

In this proof we first show that the orthonormal submatrix $X_{\cdot S}$ is contained within the set $\widehat{\beta}_{MBP}(w(X), I_D)$.

Proposition 8 *Let $X_{\cdot S}$ be a rank D orthonormal submatrix of X. Then $S \in S(\beta) : \beta \in \widehat{\beta}_{MBP}(w(X), I_D))$.*

Proof: By Proposition 1 without loss of generality, let $X_{\cdot S} = I_D$. Also, without loss of generality let $S = \{1 \dots D\}$. We show that $\beta = [I_D \ 0]$ satisfies the KKT conditions for $X = [I_D \ X_{-S}]$.

Recall that the KKT conditions for a convex optimization problem are a set of conditions on an element of the domain of the optimization algorithm that, if satisfied, certify that the element is a solution. To write out the KKT conditions, we define the Lagrangian

$$\mathcal{L}(X, \beta, \nu) = \|\beta\|_{1,2} + \nu^T(I_D - w(X)\beta) \tag{30}$$

where $\nu \in \mathbb{R}^{D\times D}$ is the dual variable.

The KKT conditions are then

- Primal feasibility: $w(X)\beta = I_D$
- Stationarity: there exists a dual variable ν such that $0 \in \partial\|\beta\|_{1,2} - w(X)^T\nu$ where ∂ is the subdifferential operator.

where dual feasibility and complementary slackness are ignorable by virtue of the absence of inequality constraints.

First note that in our case, primal feasibility is satisfied by X being rank D and w not effecting the rank of the transformed matrix since it only rescales length and not direction.

For stationarity, recall that

$$\|\beta\|_{1,2} = \sum_{p=1}^{P} \|\beta_{p\cdot}\|_2. \tag{31}$$

Then, by the definition of subdifferential

$$\partial\|\beta\|_{1,2} = \begin{bmatrix} I_D \\ v_{d+1} \\ \dots \\ v_P \end{bmatrix} \tag{32}$$

where $v_p \in \mathbb{R}^D$ can be any vector satisfying $\|v_p\|_2 \leq 1$.

We therefore must show that there exists a ν that satisfies

$$\begin{bmatrix} I_D \\ w(X_{-S})^T \end{bmatrix} \nu = \begin{bmatrix} I_D \\ V_{-S} \end{bmatrix}. \tag{33}$$

At this point we can see that in fact I_D is an appropriate choice of ν since normalization by w leads to vectors satisfying $\|w(X)\|_2 \leq 1$.

Since for this β, $S(\beta) = S$, we have shown that S is the support of a solution to $\beta_{MBP}(w(X), I_D)$. □

The next part of the proof handles the presence of non-unique solutions.

Proposition 9 $S(\widehat{\beta}(X)) = \cup\, S(\beta) \;:\; \beta \in \beta_{MBP}(w(X), I_D)$

Proof: The proposition follows from geometric properties of the solution set. We ignore the case for singleton solutions, for which the proposition is self-evident. Recall that $\widehat{\beta}(X) := \widehat{\beta}^{\ell_2}_{MBP}(w(X), I_D) = \arg\min_{\beta \in \mathbb{R}^{P\times D}} \|\beta\|_F : \beta \in \widehat{\beta}_{MBP}(X, I_D)$. By definition of $\widehat{\beta}_{MBP}(X, I_D)$, $\|\beta_{p\cdot}\|_2 : \beta \in \widehat{\beta}_{MBP}(X, I_D)$ is an affine linear subspace of $\mathbb{R}^P$. The projection of the vector of minimum ℓ_2 distance from the origin to a affine space intersects that space perpendicularly. However, for all $\|\beta_{\cdot p}\|_2$ such that β is on the intersection of this affine space with the coordinate hyperplanes formed by fixing any choices of $\|\beta_{\cdot p}\|_2 = 0$, this vector doesn't intersect this space perpendicularly. Thus, $\widehat{\beta}(X)$ is not on the intersection of the solution polytope $\widehat{\beta}_{MBP}(w(X), I_D)$ with the coordinate hyperplanes. It is therefore maximally non-sparse with respect to any of the minimizing solutions. □

2.2.3 Proof of Proposition 3

X_S admits a QR decomposition $X_S = QR$ where Q is orthogonal and R is upper triangular. By Proposition 1, we can assume without loss of generality that $Q = I_D$. That is, X_S is upper triangular. Thus, $\beta = X_S^{-1}$ is upper triangular with diagonal elements $\beta_{dd} = R^{-1}_{dd}$. $\|\beta_{d\cdot}\|_2 \geq \beta_{dd}$, with equality only occurring when the off-diagonal elements are 0. Therefore, $\|\beta_{1,2}\| \geq D$ with equality occurring only when $\beta = I_D$.

2.2.4 Proof of Proposition 5

Proof: The augmented split Lagrangian minimized by ADMM is

$$\mathcal{L}_{\rho,\gamma,\nu}(X, \beta, z) = \|z\|_{1,2} + \mathrm{tr}(\nu^T(I_D - w(X)\beta)) + \rho\|I_D - w(X)\beta\|_F^2 + \gamma\|\beta - z\|_F^2 \tag{34}$$

This minimization problem is

$$\arg \min_{\beta, z \in P\times D} \mathcal{L}_{\rho,\gamma,\nu}(X, \beta, z) \tag{35}$$

For a more detailed explanation of the reasons to prefer optimizing the split augmented Lagrangian over direct optimization of Equation 15 see Boyd (2010).

The three main subroutines (39 - 43) called by ADMM determine the per iteration complexity. The update rules of the ADMM algorithm used to optimize the augmented split Lagrangian are

$$\beta^{k+1} = \arg \min_{\beta \in P\times D} \mathcal{L}_{\rho,\gamma,\nu}(X, \beta, z^k) \tag{36}$$

$$z^{k+1} = \arg \min_{z \in P\times D} \mathcal{L}_{\rho,\gamma,\nu}(X, \beta^{k+1}, z) \tag{37}$$

$$\nu^{k+1} = \nu^k + \rho(I_D - w(X)\beta^{k+1}) \tag{38}$$

We will analyze the computational complexity of each of these steps by rewriting the update rules according to the specifics of the isometry pursuit problem.

The beta update Equation 39 projects the solution onto the feasible set.

$$\beta^{k+1} = \arg\min_{\beta \in P \times D} \operatorname{tr}({\nu^k}^T (I_D - w(X)\beta)) + \rho \|I_D - w(X)\beta\|_2^2 + \gamma \|\beta - z^k\|_2^2 \tag{39}$$

$$= (\rho\, w(X)^T w(X) + \gamma I_D)^{-1} (\rho\, w(X)^T I_D + \gamma z^k + w(X)^T \nu^k) \tag{40}$$

The computational complexity of this computation is dominated by the inverse - that is, $O(D^2 P)$.

Subsequently, the z update Equation 41 is soft-thresholding operation onto a contracted level set $\|\|_{1,2}$ ball.

$$z^{k+1} = \arg\min_{z \in P \times D} \|z\|_{1,2} + \gamma \|z - \beta^{k+1}\|_2^2 \tag{41}$$

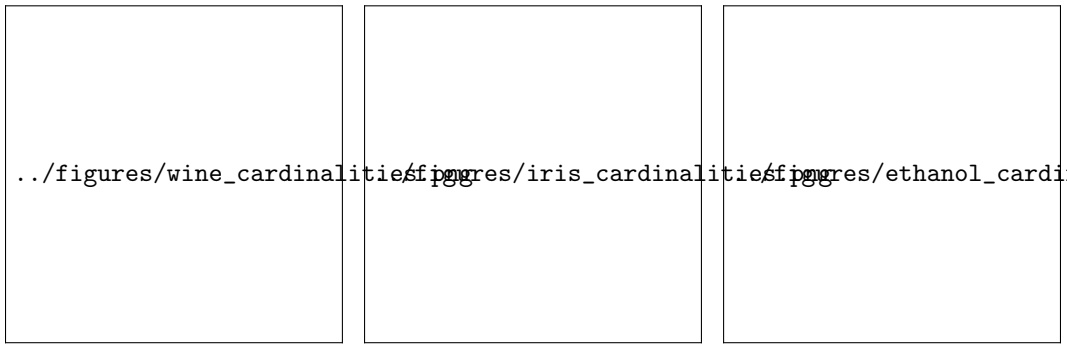
$$= \begin{cases} (1 - \frac{1}{\gamma \|\beta_{j\cdot}^{k+1}\|_2})(\beta_{j\cdot}^{k+1}) \text{ if } \|\beta_{j\cdot}^{k+1}\|_2 > \frac{1}{\gamma} \\ 0 \text{ otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{42}$$

The computational complexity of this operation is $O(PD)$.

Finally, the ν update Equation 43 increases the squeezing of the z and β variables towards to each other.

$$\nu^{k+1} = \nu^k + \rho(I_D - w(X)\beta^{k+1}) \tag{43}$$

In this step, the dual variable ν that controls the penalty accrued by the splitting is updated in the direction of the constraint violation. The computational complexity of this operation is dominated by that of the matrix multiplication $w(X)\beta^{k+1}$. That is, it is $O(D^2 P)$. □



(a) Wine (b) Iris (c) Ethanol

Figure 3: Support cardinalities for each dataset after IsometryPursuit.

2.3 Support cardinalities

Figure 3 plots the distribution of $|\widehat{S}_{IP}|$ from Table **??** in order to contextualize the reported means. While typically $|\widehat{S}_{IP}| << P$, there are cases for Ethanol where this is not the case that drive up the means. Further investigation into the extreme failure of isometry pursuit to sparsify in the the minor chunk of the bimodal Ethanol support cardinality distribution is warranted.

2.4 Timing

While wall-time of algorithms is a non-theoretical quantity that depends on implementation details, it provides valuable context for practitioners. We therefore report the following runtimes on a 2021 Macbook Pro. The particularly high variance for brute force search in the second step of TwoStageIsometryPursuit is likely due to the large cardinalities reported in Figure 3.

Name	IP	2nd stage	Greedy
Iris	1.24 ± 0.02	0.00 ± 0.00	0.02 ± 0.00
Wine	2.32 ± 0.17	0.13 ± 0.12	0.03 ± 0.00
Ethanol	8.38 ± 0.57	0.55 ± 1.08	0.07 ± 0.01

Table 2: Algorithm runtimes in seconds across replicates.

Example 2

$$X_S = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & \frac{-1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} & \frac{-1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} & \frac{-1}{2} \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & 0 & 0 & & \\ 0 & 0 & \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 00 & 0 & \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & \end{bmatrix}. \tag{44}$$

Proof: Let

By Given the symmetry of the second and third columns around the y axis, the loss will not change regardless of whether we upweight one or downweight the other, these changes necessarily being in conjunction. We therefore assume that their loadings with respect to the second column of the target matrix (the D dimensional identity) are the same. Clearly, they will both then have value of $\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$. The question then becomes, what should the values of the first column in the loading matrix β be?

We can answer this question with a simple differential equation. Let b denote the constraint violation $1 - X_{1.}\beta_{.1}$.

Then

$$\frac{\partial b}{\partial \beta_{11}} = \frac{\partial b}{\partial \beta_{21}} \tag{45}$$

$$= \frac{1}{2} \tag{46}$$

On the other hand, due to the value of $\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$ already assumed for the second loading of the second and third features,

$$\frac{\partial l}{\partial \beta_{11}} = \frac{\partial l}{\partial \beta_{21}} \tag{47}$$

$$= \frac{\partial}{\partial x}\sqrt{\frac{1}{3} + x^2} \tag{48}$$

$$= \frac{1}{2}(\frac{1}{3} + x^2)^{-\frac{1}{2}}(2x) \tag{49}$$

$$= \frac{x}{\sqrt{\frac{1}{3} + x^2}}. \tag{50}$$

This means that the tradeoff

$$\frac{\partial l}{\partial b} = \frac{1}{2x}\sqrt{\frac{1}{3} + x^2}. \tag{51}$$

In contrast, $\frac{\partial l}{\partial \beta_{11}} = 1$ and similarly for its constraint violation. Solving for the equilibrium, we get

$$\frac{1}{2x}\sqrt{\frac{1}{3} + x^2} = 1 \tag{52}$$

$$\frac{1}{3} + x^2 = 4x^2 \tag{53}$$

$$\frac{1}{3} = 3x^2 \tag{54}$$

$$x = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}. \tag{55}$$

This leads to a value for l of

$$\sqrt{\frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{9}} + \sqrt{\frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{9}} + \frac{2}{3} \tag{56}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{4}{9}} + \sqrt{\frac{4}{9}} + \frac{2}{3} \tag{57}$$

$$= \frac{2}{3} + \frac{2}{3} + \frac{2}{3} \tag{58}$$

□